



SEPSIS

Effective: January 1, 2026
Replaces: January 1, 2025

1. Patient Care Goals

- 1.1. Maintain systolic blood pressure greater than 90 mmHg to ensure adequate perfusion
- 1.2. Administer fluids to address tachycardia, hypotension, or signs of circulatory compromise
- 1.3. Identification of Systemic Inflammatory Response Syndrome (SIRS) Criteria
 - 1.3.1. Temperature less than 96 °F or greater than 100.4 °F
 - 1.3.2. Heart rate greater than 90 bpm
 - 1.3.3. Respiratory rate greater than 20 bpm
 - 1.3.4. ETCO2 less than 25 mmHg
- 1.4. Advanced notification to hospital of suspected sepsis patient if two or more SIRS criteria are met

2. BLS Treatment

- 2.1. Routine Medical Care – Adult **(700-S04)**
 - 2.1.1. **Oxygen** – titrate as appropriate
- 2.2. Place patient in recovery position or position of comfort
- 2.3. Treat associated signs and symptoms of shock as appropriate **(700-A10)**

3. ALS Treatment

- 3.1. **Vascular Access (IV)**, TKO, large bore when possible
 - 3.1.1. A second **IV** or **Saline Lock** may be established if appropriate
- 3.2. Rapid Fluid Resuscitation, up to 1 L, in 250 ml increments to maintain systolic blood pressure of 90 mmHg. Reassess vital signs between fluid boluses. Titrate fluids once a systolic pressure of 90 mmHg is achieved
- 3.3. If unable to achieve target systolic blood pressure after fluid bolus and signs/symptoms of shock are present, administer **Push-dose Epinephrine** per **(700-A10)**
- 3.4. If fever (>100.4 °F) present, **Acetaminophen 1000 mg** (for adult patients weighing 50 kg or more) **IV Piggyback or IV Drip** may be administered, delivered over fifteen (15) minutes

4. Pertinent Assessment Findings

- 4.1. Signs of infection can include:
 - 4.1.1. Lungs – Cough, dyspnea, chest pain, sputum production
 - 4.1.2. Genitourinary – Dysuria, discharge, abdominal/flank pain
 - 4.1.3. Skin/soft tissue – Rashes, erythema, broken skin/decubitus ulcers, joint pain
 - 4.1.4. CNS – Headaches, convulsions, photophobia, neck pain
 - 4.1.5. Gastrointestinal – Diarrhea, vomiting, abdominal pain, jaundice

5. Key Documentation Elements

- 5.1. Assessment findings indicative of infection
- 5.2. Abnormal vital sign findings
- 5.3. Response to medication/procedures